



National Archives and Records Administration

8601 Adelphi Road
College Park, Maryland 20740-6001

LIST OF DOCUMENTATION

System and/or File Title:

**Awards Information Management System
(AIMS), July 15, 1988 – March 25, 2004**

	Number of Pages
I. NARA Documentation (Folder 1)	
1. List of Documentation	1 pg.
2. User Note	5 pg.
3. Supplemental User Note	1 pg.
4. Public Use File Record Layout	2 pg.
II. Agency Documentation	
1. Action Area Code List (Folder 2)	2 pg.
2. Data Descriptions (Record Layouts) (Folder 3)	18 pg.
3. Functional Descriptions (Version 1.2), January 1990 (Folder 4)	101 pg.
4. Program Maintenance and Operations Manual; January 1993 (Folder 5)	182 pg.
5. Terms and Abbreviations (Folder 6)	4 pg.
6. Users Manual (Version 1.4), February 1993 (Folders 7 & 8)	235 pg.
Total	551 pg.
III. NARA Processing Materials	
1. Automated Validation of Electronic Records (Folders 9 - 19)	
2. File Sample Printouts (Folders 20 - 30)	

Accession No.: NN3-428-02-002

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Page 1 of 1

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USER NOTE

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I. Relationship of the AIMS Files

The Board of Decorations and Medals of the Secretary of the Navy, Department of the Navy transferred two data files, seven code files, and one documentation file for the Awards Information Management System (AIMS), July 15, 1988 – March 25, 2004. The two data files are the Active AIMS data file and the Participating Commands data file. The seven code files are the Action Area, Awards Authorization, Awards, Campaign, Corps, Grades, and Ratings code files. The documentation file is a text file of the data and code file record layouts. The table below lists the description, file names, and identification / XMIS number for the AIMS files.

Description	File Name	XMIS Number
Active data file	AIMS.8804.HIST	085041
Participating Commands data file	AIMS.8804.PCMDS	085042
Action Area code file	AIMS.8804.CD.ACT	085043
Awards Authorization code file	AIMS.8804.CD.AUTH	085044
Awards code file	AIMS.8804.CD.AWD	085045
Campaign code file	AIMS.8804.CD.CAMP	085046
Corps code file	AIMS.8804.CD.CORP	085047
Grades code file	AIMS.8804.CD.GRD	085048
Ratings code file	AIMS.8804.CD.RATE	085049
Documentation text file	AIMS.8804.CD.DOC	085050

II. Documentation

An asterisk (*) in the Active AIMS Data Table (Record Layout) in the agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions indicates that those columns are associated with the History data file.

III. Discrepancies Within the Documentation

Minor discrepancies within the documentation were discovered during the data verification process for the Awards Information Management System (AIMS), July 15, 1988 – March 25, 2004. The explanations of the discrepancies are listed by Record Layout, alphabetically by Column Name, and are described below.

Active AIMS Data Table (Record Layout)

LTR_TYPE: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the values in the data element LTR_TYPE in record positions 800 – 804. The agency documentation states that the “options are explained in Appendix G.” The codes for LTR_TYPE are found in pages H-2 and H-3 of Appendix H in the Users Manual, version 1.4, dated February, 1993 (Folder 8).

IV. Data

According to the agency Technical Point of Contact (POC), the Active data file does not contain all the records from AIMS but contains only those records for awards which have been completely processed. The records for awards which have been completely processed are the set of records found in the History data file in previous accessions. The primary difference between the Active data file and the previous History data files is that the records in the Active data file contains additional columns or fields with data not found in the record layout of the History data files.

The PCMD_ID field, the Participating Commands ID, is the primary key for the Active and Participating Commands data files. PCMD_ID is found in record positions 1103 – 1113 in the Active data file and in record positions 1 – 11 in the Participating Commands data file.

V. Discrepancies Between the Data and Documentation

Minor discrepancies between the data and documentation were discovered during the data verification process for the files of the Awards Information Management System (AIMS), July 15, 1988 – March 25, 2004. The discrepancies are characters within the data that were not within the expected values listed in the documentation. The explanations of the differences are listed by data file, alphabetically by Column Name, and are described below.

Active Aims Data File

Date fields: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the date format with an example as 01-JAN-97. Data in the date fields has two formats which do not match the example in the documentation. The date is 11 records positions in length in a format of __MMDDYYYY in which the first three record positions are blank, two record positions (MM) are the month, two record positions (DD) are the day, and four record positions (YYYY) are the year.

ACTION_AREA: The Action Area code file lists the 18 codes for the data element ACTION_AREA in record positions 390 - 391. A large number of records contain

Accession No.: NN3-428-04-002

Prepared by: J. Powell, Archives Specialist

Date: July 26, 2004

Page 2 of 5

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values not found in the code list. See the AERIC Verification Statement (Folder 11), pages 167 – 171.

ACTION_TYPE: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element ACTION_TYPE in record positions 359 – 360 as 01, 02, 03, 04, 05, or 06. A number of records contain the values of 0, 0&, 0-, 00, 07, 08, 0A, 0B, 0C, 0I, 0M, 0R, 0S, 0Z, 0ÿ, H3, M3, and MS.

APPR_AWD: The Awards code file lists the 96 codes for the data element APPR_AWD in record positions 419 - 420. A number of records contain the values of 00, 01, 09, 12, 24, 26, 32, 34, 38, 39, 41, 42, 46, 54, 64, 65, 66, 75, 77, 90, 93, 99, ;L, AN CN, CP, FO, HO, JX, L, MA, N, NN, NY, SV, ZU, a closing bracket (]), and]C.

APPR_AWD_NUM: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the values in the data element APPR_AWD_NUM in record positions 363 - 364 from 00 – 99. A small number of records contain the values of)7, -1, //, ?U, 0!, 0*, 0-, 0<, 0B, 0I, 0P, 0Z, 0{, 1X, 2X, B1, D1, E4, E6, N1, N3, NA, NC, O1, O2, O3, O4, U1, UN, and X7.

APPR_EH: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element APPR_EH in record position 874 as Y or N. A single record contains the value of O.

AWD_AUTH: The Awards Authority code file lists the 34 codes for the data element AWD_AUTH in record position 421. A small number of records contain the values of an exclamation mark (!), an asterisk ('), a dash (-), a period (.), a forward slash (/), an opening bracket ([), a closing bracket (]), and a vertical line (|). A large number of records contain the values of A and O.

AWD_MUL_DATE: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the description for the data element AWD_MUL_DATE in record positions 875 - 876 as the "Sequence number for one award with multiple dates, starting with 1." A small number of records have two asterisks (**).

CAMPAIGN: The Campaigns code file lists the 27 codes for the data element CAMPAIGN in record positions 53 - 57. A number of records contain the values of CCCCC, SDEMO, ST OR, STOR, TYPHO, freed, ifree, and storm.

CLS: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element CLS in record position 17 as C, S, or U. A single record contains the values of 2 and u.

COMPONENT: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element COMPONENT in record positions 282 – 286 as USN, USNR, USMC, USMCR, USA, USAR, USAF, USAFR, or USCG. A number of records contain the values of F, NA, OTHER, RRRRR, SPA, USCGR, and USNS.

CORPS_MEM: The Corps code file lists the 8 codes for the data element CORPS_MEM in record positions 329 - 331. A large number of records contain values not found in the code list. See the AERIC Verification Statement (Folder 11), pages 155 - 165.

COUNTRY: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the description for the data element COUNTRY in record positions 28 – 52 as the "Country of the Foreign individual."

Accession No.: NN3-428-04-002

Prepared by: J. Powell, Archives Specialist

Date: July 26, 2004

Page 3 of 5

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The values found include the country name, misspellings of country names, names of cities followed by the country name, names of regions followed by country names, abbreviations, alphanumeric characters, and symbols.

- DESIG_NEC_MOS: The Ratings code file lists the 664 codes for the data element DESIG_NEC_MOS in record positions 325 - 328. A large number of records contain values not found in the code list. See the AERIC Verification Statement (Folder 11), pages 32 - 155.
- DUTY_STAT: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element DUTY_STAT in record positions 268 - 270 as RET, REL, DET, SPA, UNK, PTO, or NA. A single record contains the value of ZZZ.
- GRADE_RATING: The Grade code file lists the 66 codes for the data element GRADE_RATING in record positions 313 - 322. A large number of records contain values not found in the code list. See the AERIC Verification Statement (Folder 11), pages 11 - 32.
- LTR_TYPE: Appendix H in the AIMS Users Manual, version 1.4, dated February, 1993 lists the 11 codes for the data element LTR_TYPE in record positions 800 - 804. A number of records contain the values of IVNEH, S003, UBASC, UBCIV, UBCNL, UBCNM, UDREC, UNOWD, UREMD, UVCIV, UVCNL, UVCNM, UVICE, and XXXXX.
- MERIT_MOS: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the description for the data element MERIT_MOS in record positions 387 - 388 as the "Number of months in Merit award period." A small number of records contain the values of 01, /K, 0>, 0A, 0B, 0C, 0S, 0\, 1(, 1>, 1A, 1C, 1D, 1E, 1H, 1K, 1S, 1U, 1{, 2(, 2/, 2A, 2B, 2E, 2I, 2O, 2S, 2U, 3(, 3>, 3C, 3O, 4C, 5", 5M, 5U, 6M, *M, 8S, >=, DC, O4, S7, S9, SE, SV, T5, TE, US, XU, XX, and Z8.
- OFF_ENL: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element OFF_ENL in record position 312 as O, E, W, or M. A number of records contain the values of an ampersand (&), closing parenthesis ()), forward slash (?), 0 - 8, B - D, F - L, N, P, R - U, and Z.
- PRIM_TYPE: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element PRIM_TYPE in record positions 2 - 4 as CNO, CMC, SEC, or FLT. A small number of records contain the values of 19- and UUU.
- RECMD_AWD: The Awards code file lists the 96 codes for the data element RECMD_AWD in record positions 337 - 338. A large number of records contain values not found in the code list. See the AERIC Verification Statement (Folder 11), pages 165 - 166.
- SEC_DIR_END: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element SEC_DIR_END in record position 16 as D, E, or N. A single record contains the values of L and S.
- SEC_ENDRSR: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element

Accession No.: NN3-428-04-002

Prepared by: J. Powell, Archives Specialist

Date: July 26, 2004

Page 4 of 5

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- SEC_ENDRSR in record positions 403 – 405 as CMC or CNO. A small number of records contain the value of BLA.
- SEC_ENDRSR_RECND: The Awards code file lists the 96 codes for the data element SEC_ENDRSR_RECND in record positions 406 - 407. A small number of records contain the values of a comma (,), KK, an a leading asterisk (`), and a vertical line (|).
- SEC_RECIP: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element SEC_RECIP in record positions 856 - 861 as SECNAV, M&RA, ADMIN, MAILRM, or UNSEC. A small number of records contain the values of CNO, MRA, OTOPSC, SRACKS, and ZZZZZZ.
- SECBD: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element SECBD in record position 58 as S, V, N, or W. A single record contains the value of L.
- SECBD_EH: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element SECBD_EH in record position 844 as Y or N. A small number of records contain the value of I.
- SECBD_RECND_AWD: The Awards code file lists the 96 codes for the data element SECBD_RECND_AWD in record positions 840 - 841. A single record contains the value of YY.
- SHIP: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element SHIP in record position 879 as Y or N. Two records contain the value of X.
- TRANS_METHOD: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions for the Active AIMS Data Table lists the codes for the data element TRANS_METHOD in record position 862 as 1, 2, 3, or 4. A single record contains the value of E and N.

Code Files

Date fields: The agency documentation titled Awards Information System (AIMS) Data Descriptions does not list the format for the date fields in the seven code files. The date is 16 records positions in length in a format of MM/DD/YYYY_HHHH:SS. In the format, M is month, D is day, Y is year, H is hour in the 24-hour clock system, and S is seconds.



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SUPPLEMENTAL USER NOTE

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I. Public Use File

In 2005 NARA staff created a public use version of the Awards Information Management System (AIMS), July 15, 1988-March 25, 2004 Active data file. The public use file includes only the fields designated on the agency record layout as part of the History data file (indicated by an asterisk (*) on the layout). The public use file also replaces the characters in the social security number field with Xs and includes only records where the award approval date was before December 31, 1994 due to Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) b(6) personal privacy restrictions.

AWARDS INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (AIMS), 1988-2004 PUBLIC USE FILE
RECORD LAYOUT

Data Element	Description	Start	End	Width	Comments
INDV_UNIT	INDIVIDUAL OR UNIT CASE.	1	1	1	
PRIM_TYPE	INDICATES CASE TYPE	2	4	3	
FOREIGN	WHETHER AWARD IS TO A FOREIGN INDIVIDUAL	5	5	1	
COUNTRY	COUNTRY OF FOREIGN INDIVIDUAL	6	30	25	
CAMPAIGN	PERIOD OF ACTION	31	35	5	
SECBD_MTG	SECNAV BOARD MEETING DATE	36	46	11	
DUP	DUPLICATE RECORD INDICATOR	47	48	2	
SSN	SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER	49	59	11	Restricted Data
LNAME	LAST NAME.	60	79	20	
FNAME	FIRST NAME	80	94	15	
MNAME	MIDDLE NAME	95	109	15	
SUFFIX	ENDING TO LAST NAME	110	114	5	
COMPONENT	BRANCH OF SERVICE	115	119	5	
OFF_ENL	OFFICER OR ENLISTED INDIV.	120	120	1	
GRADE_RATING	ABBREVIATION OF RANK	121	130	10	
PAY_GRADE	CODE FOR GRADE AND PAY	131	132	2	
DESIG_NEC_MOS	CODES FOR OFFICERS AND ENLISTED PERSONNEL	133	136	4	
CORPS_MEM	INDICATES MEMBERSHIP IN A SPECIFIC CORPS	137	139	3	
BUIC_RUC	UNIT/COMMAND ID CODE	140	144	5	
RECMD_AWD	RECOMMENDED AWARD	145	146	2	
BILLET	DUTY ASSIGNMENT	147	166	20	
ACTION_TYPE	TYPE OF ACTION COMMENDED BY THE ORIGINATOR	167	168	2	
APPR_AWD_NUM	NUMBER OF TIMES THIS AWARD HAS BEEN GIVEN	169	170	2	
MERIT_START	START OF AWD MERIT PERIOD	171	181	11	
MERID_END	END OF AWD MERIT PERIOD	182	192	11	
MERIT_MOS	NUMBER OF MONTHS IN MERIT AWARD PERIOD	193	194	2	
SHOW_MERIT_DATE	INDICATOR FOR DISPLAYING MERIT_START_DATE AND MERIT_END_DATE ON REPORTS	195	195	1	
ACTION_AREA	GEOGRAPHIC AREA IN WHICH THE AWARD WAS EARNED	196	197	2	
ORIG_RECMD_DATE	DATE AWARD RECOMMENDED	198	208	11	
SEC_ENDRSR_RECMD	NAME OF AWARD ENDORSED BY CNO OR CMC.	209	210	2	
ENDRSMT_DATE	DATE ENDORSER SIGNS CASE	211	221	11	
APPR_AWD	NAME OF APPROVED AWARD	222	223	2	
AWD_AUTH	AWARDING AUTHORITY CODE.	224	224	1	
APPR_AWD_DATE	DATE AWARD APPROVED.	225	235	11	
SEC_SER_NUM	SECNAV CASE SERIAL NUMBER	236	239	4	
SECBD_RECMD_AWD	NAME OF THE AWARD RECOMMENDED BY THE SECNAV BOARD	240	241	2	
SECBD_EH	INDICATES WHETHER SECNAV BOARD RECOMMEND EXTRAORDINARY HEROISM OR IF RECIPIENT IS INELIGIBLE	242	242	1	
APPR_EH	SECNAV APPROVED EXTRAORDINARY HEROISM.	243	243	1	
AWD_MUL_DATE	SEQUENCE NUMBER FOR ONE AWARD WITH MULTIPLE DATES, STARTING WITH 1	244	245	2	

Accession No.: NN3-428-04-002

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Date: February 25, 2005

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RECORD LAYOUT

Data Element	Description	Start	End	Width	Comments
TOTAL_MUL_DATE	TOTAL NUMBER OF DATES ASSOCIATED WITH AN AWARD	246	247	2	
SHIP	SPECIFIES WHETHER UNIT AWARD IS FOR A SHIP	248	248	1	
CNO_SER_NUM	O9B33 SERIAL NUMBER	249	256	8	
MAIL_DATE	DATE O9B33 MAILS COMPLETED CASE	257	267	11	
MAILED_TO	CNO MAILED AWARD TO	268	307	40	
AWD_REMARKS	REMARKS CODE FOR UNIT AWARDS REPORT	308	310	3	
PCMD_ID	PARTICIPATING COMMANDS ID	311	321	11	
MUL_ID	MULTIPLE RECORD ID	322	329	8	
CMC_TO_MHM	DATE FROM CMC.	330	340	11	
ENTRY_DATE	DATE RECORD WAS ENTERED	341	356	16	
CHANGE_DATE	DATE RECORD WAS MODIFIED	357	372	16	

Accession No.: NN3-428-04-002

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Page 2 of 2